

Review of the mid year claims note of 10 July 2026

To: Publication committee From: Publications desk Date: 6 October 2026 Standard: published figures, review standard

Outcome

The figure is **reissued**. It does not reproduce on the basis its label gives, and the review establishes the basis it was computed on: the same twelve states and series, with each half year taken one week later than the label says, the weeks ending **10 January to 4 July 2026** against **11 January to 5 July 2025**. On that basis the statement reproduces in every number: **1,058,808** against **1,211,608**, a fall of **12.6 percent**. We publish it again with that basis in its label, and beside it the figure on the basis of the original label: **1,082,313** against **1,230,465**, a fall of **12.0 percent**, for the weeks ending 3 January to 27 June 2026 against 4 January to 28 June 2025. The figure does not stand and is not withdrawn.

The committee member's figures

They are right. On the basis the label gives, the record sums to 1,082,313 for the first half of 2026 and 1,230,465 for the first half of 2025, a fall of 12.0 percent. That is the figure published beside the reissued one, and the label on it is the label the note carried.

What the published figure measured and how it was established

Step (a) of the standard: the label's basis gives 1,082,313, 1,230,465 and -12.0, none of which equals the published number, so the figure does not stand. Step (b): the reviewer tested alternative specifications of the four elements of a basis, the states, the weeks in each period, the series column and the formula, against all three published numbers. Holding the twelve states, the regular program count column and the formula fixed and moving both windows one week later reproduces the statement exactly: 1,058,808, 1,211,608 and -12.6. No other specification tested reproduces the count 1,058,808: not the Department of Labor's Chicago and Kansas City regions in place of the Census region, not the window moved by any other number of weeks or made a week longer or shorter, not the twelve states less any one or two of them. The percentage alone is less selective: 12.6 is also what the eleven states without Indiana give on the label's window (1,005,869 against 1,150,465), and what the ten states of the Chicago and Kansas City regions give on the later window (1,043,263 against 1,193,103); neither carries the published totals, so under rule 3 neither is the basis. The later window is what a spreadsheet keyed by the Sunday a week begins produces when the half year is filtered on that date, and what the tracker's own revision note describes for its 2021 error, claims assigned to the report date rather than the week they reflect; which of these happened cannot be known without the working files, and the standard does not require it, since the basis is established by reproduction.

What the two bases exchange, week by week

Year	Leaves the window	Claims	Enters the window	Claims	Net	Label total	Basis total
2026	week ending 03 January	69,759	week ending 04 July	46,254	-23,505	1,082,313	1,058,808
2025	week ending 04 January	74,195	week ending 05 July	55,338	-18,857	1,230,465	1,211,608

Twenty five of the twenty six weeks are the same in both bases. The week that leaves is the first week of the year, which carries the post holiday surge in filings (69,759 in 2026, 74,195 in 2025), and the week that enters is the first week of July, a low week (46,254 and 55,338). The exchange lowers both totals, 2026 by 23,505 and 2025 by 18,857, and because the 2026 total loses more in proportion the fall deepens from 12.0 to 12.6 percent. The record has one vintage in the workspace, the combined claims column is empty for every week since the pandemic programs ended, and the rate columns are per hundred of the 2019 labour force, so none of these accounts for the difference; the window does, exactly.

By state

State	Label 2026	Label 2025	Change %	Basis 2026	Basis 2025	Change %	Shift, points
Illinois	222,377	273,013	-18.5	218,693	270,567	-19.2	-0.7
Indiana	76,444	80,000	-4.4	74,043	77,495	-4.5	-0.1
Iowa	51,736	59,809	-13.5	49,427	58,400	-15.4	-1.9

State	Label 2026	Label 2025	Change %	Basis 2026	Basis 2025	Change %	Shift, points
Kansas	35,224	36,940	-4.6	34,445	36,851	-6.5	-1.9
Michigan	178,466	214,026	-16.6	172,695	217,329	-20.5	-3.9
Minnesota	132,325	136,731	-3.2	128,615	132,761	-3.1	0.1
Missouri	88,830	100,219	-11.4	92,663	96,903	-4.4	7.0
Nebraska	21,356	24,168	-11.6	20,901	24,186	-13.6	-2.0
North Dakota	10,304	12,305	-16.3	9,950	12,855	-22.6	-6.3
Ohio	155,422	170,988	-9.1	153,142	168,682	-9.2	-0.1
South Dakota	5,761	5,804	-0.7	5,595	5,650	-1.0	-0.3
Wisconsin	104,068	116,462	-10.6	98,639	109,929	-10.3	0.3
Midwest Region	1,082,313	1,230,465	-12.0	1,058,808	1,211,608	-12.6	-0.6

The state whose change moves most between the two bases is **Missouri**: a fall of 11.4 percent on the label and of 4.4 percent on the basis the note used, 7.0 points apart. In 2026 Missouri's first July week (8,857) carried more claims than its first week of the year (5,024), while in 2025 the first week of the year (6,840) was the heavier of the two (3,524 in July), so the exchange raises Missouri's 2026 total and lowers its 2025 total. North Dakota moves next most, 6.3 points the other way. No state changes direction: every state fell on both bases.

Reply to the committee member

Thank you for checking the note. Your figures are right: on the basis the note's label gives, the record shows 1,082,313 against 1,230,465, a fall of 12.0 percent. The review under the office's standard found that the published numbers were computed on windows one week later than the label, the weeks ending 10 January to 4 July 2026 against 11 January to 5 July 2025, on which they reproduce exactly. Under the standard the figure is reissued rather than withdrawn: it will be published again with that basis in its label, with the figure on the original label, your figure, beside it, and the difference accounted for week by week as above.